

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1219

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Larry Earl Bland, Sr., of Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Larry Earl Bland, Sr., of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Larry Bland was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bland was born on January 2, 1950, in Memphis, the seventh child of Joe C. and Edith Randolph Bland; he began his Christian journey at a young age at the Princeton Chapel A.M.E. Zion Church under the leadership of Reverend Earnest S. Johnson; and

WHEREAS, Larry Bland was a 1968 graduate of Douglass High School, where he played drums in the band and competed in track, and he attended barber school in the evenings; and

WHEREAS, after high school, Mr. Bland married Lorece, with whom he welcomed two children, Guenevere "Cookie" and Larry, Jr.;

WHEREAS, after graduating from barber school, Larry Bland worked side-by-side with his father, Joe, at the barber shop and at Firestone Tire Plant; following his father's passing, Mr. Bland opened Larry Bland's Barber Shop and Hairstyles, where he became a well-known and respected master barber in the community; and

WHEREAS, Larry Bland dedicated five decades to cultivating a reputation for loyalty, commitment, and excellence in a business he cherished, working alongside his children Cookie

and Jr.; he loved what he did and never saw the barber shop as work because it was his passion; and

WHEREAS, Bland's Barbershop is more than just a place to get a haircut—it is a nearly eighty-year-old legacy business, a symbol of Black entrepreneurship in Memphis, and a community institution that has survived economic shifts, neighborhood changes, and generational transitions; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bland was also deeply committed to dancing, dedicating significant time to participating in events with the Smooth Steppers of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Larry Bland was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bland is survived by his son, Larry, Jr. (Shandra); two daughters, Guenevere and Camilla (Tony); grandsons, Judstin, Sr., and Caleb; great-grandchildren, Judstin, Jr., and Jooni; two sisters, Margaret Bland-Larry and L. Annette Bland; brother, Cleophus "Scrap" (Regina) Bland; goddaughters, Tonya Bonner and Michelle Anderson Walker; special son, Mario (Jessica) Anderson; dear friend, Jerri Huggins; and a host of nieces, nephews, cousins, and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Larry Bland was preceded in death by his brothers, Francis Leon Bland and Charles Lawrence "Chuck" Bland, and sisters, Georgia Bland-Gleese and Josephine Bland-Johnson; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bland leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that that we honor the memory of Larry Earl Bland, Sr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we offer our deepest sympathies and condolences to the family of Mr. Bland.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.